

Manish Gaud

UX/UI & Product Designer

[LinkedIn](#) | [Portfolio](#)

+91-7523093327

manish.d.gaud@gmail.com

Bangalore, India

PROFILE

Product designer with an M.Des from IIT Guwahati and 2+ years shipping end-to-end features across SaaS, HRIS, and fintech platforms. Currently contracting with a US-based investment research company (Zacks); experienced designing complex, multi-persona products independently from discovery through handoff. Open to full-time and contract roles.

EDUCATION

Degree/Certificate	Institute/Board	CGPA/Percentage	Year
M.Des	Indian Institute of Technology, Guwahati	8.43	2025
B.Tech	BBD Institute of Technology & Management	80.56%	2019
Senior Secondary	Kendriya Vidyalaya (CBSE Board)	78.33%	2015
Secondary	Kendriya Vidyalaya (CBSE Board)	8.2	2013

EXPERIENCE

- Zacks Investment Research** Apr 2026 – Present
Product Designer (Contract) Remote
 - Leading end-to-end redesign of the Zacks website and core product, defining UX strategy and visual direction aligned with the platform’s primary investor user group.
 - Designed Portfolio and Advisor Review features from scratch — mapping user flows, building high-fidelity prototypes, and iterating through stakeholder reviews to final handoff.
 - Established a design system to ensure scalability and visual consistency across product and marketing surfaces.
 - Operated an AI-assisted design workflow using Claude and Figma — generating design directions at speed and refining outputs to production quality.
- PeopleHum** Jul 2025 – Mar 2026
UX/UI Designer Bangalore
 - Shipped 8+ product features end-to-end across the HRIS and payroll platforms, including LMS (Udemy Integration), Goal Revamp, Breaks Management, Bulk Document Signing, and Leaves Year-End Processing.
 - Designed Zimbabwe Payroll and Hourly Payroll modules from scratch, navigating multi-country compliance requirements and complex edge cases across employer and employee personas.
 - Built a customizable Rating Scale component system and contributed to the design system, enabling consistent, reusable UI patterns across the platform.
 - Pioneered AI-assisted design workflows — leveraging Claude and Figma to accelerate ideation, component generation, and design system documentation.
 - Conducted design reviews with developers, PMs, and cofounders; supported QA handoffs to ensure implementation accuracy and design fidelity.
- Cosoot Sustainability** Apr 2025 – Jun 2025
UX/UI Designer Intern Remote
 - Designed core product interfaces for a sustainability-focused enterprise SaaS platform, improving usability across key workflows for carbon accounting and reporting.
 - Collaborated with the founder and engineering team to deliver scalable design solutions tailored to the complexity of GHG data and enterprise workflows.
- Zenskar** May 2024 – Aug 2024
Visual Design Intern Remote
 - Drove a full website revamp — designing custom web components aligned with Zenskar’s design system and brand identity, improving visual clarity and product positioning.
 - Created product feature illustrations that simplified complex billing and revenue recognition concepts for both technical and non-technical audiences.
 - Produced marketing assets including blog banners and social media content using MidJourney AI, in line with brand guidelines.
- Edugorilla** Sep 2022 – Dec 2022
Graphic Illustrator Lucknow
 - Created educational illustrations for children’s books, maintaining consistency with the existing visual style across a multi-title series.
 - Collaborated with the content team to ensure illustrations reinforced learning outcomes and matched curriculum goals.

PROJECTS

- **Zacks – Portfolio & Advisor Review Feature**

Product Design (Live project) | Zacks Investment Research

- Designed end-to-end UX for the Portfolio and Advisor Review workflows on the Zacks platform, enabling investors and financial advisors to analyze holdings, review performance, and act on insights.
- Led discovery, user flow mapping, wireframing, and high-fidelity design through to developer handoff — working directly with stakeholders across product and engineering.

- **PeopleHum – Payroll & HRIS Feature Suite**

Product Design (Live project) | PeopleHum

- Designed a suite of payroll and HR features including Zimbabwe Payroll, Hourly Payroll, Bulk Document Signing, and Breaks Management — each spanning multiple user personas and complex compliance requirements.
- Delivered end-to-end on each feature: stakeholder alignment, user flows, high-fidelity UI, and QA-reviewed developer hand-offs.

- **Cosoot Sustainability – Scope 3 Emissions Module**

UX/UI Design (Live project) | Cosoot

- Designed a Scope 3 emissions calculation experience to help organizations navigate complex GHG reporting requirements and supplier-dependent data.
- Worked with the founder and domain experts to translate GHG protocols into intuitive flows — enabling users to select calculation methods, request supplier data, and track reporting progress.

- **Octa – Marketing Campaign Management Dashboard**

UX/UI Design (Concept project)

- Designed a campaign management dashboard integrating planning, execution, and real-time analytics — enabling marketers to manage and refine strategies from a single surface.
- Conducted user interviews with marketers to map workflows and pain points, translating insights into high-fidelity prototypes.

SKILLS

- **Design Tools:** Figma, Adobe Photoshop, Illustrator, InDesign, After Effects, Premiere Pro, Fresco, Procreate, MidJourney
- **UX & Product Design:** End-to-End Product Design, User Research, Information Architecture, User Flows, Wireframing, High-Fidelity Prototyping, Design Systems, Visual Design, Interaction Design, Developer Handoff
- **Emerging Practices:** AI-Assisted Design Workflows (Claude + Figma), Prompt-Driven Ideation, Generative UI Exploration
- **Soft Skills:** Cross-functional Collaboration, Stakeholder Communication, Problem-solving, Attention to Detail, Ownership, Empathy

CERTIFICATIONS & COURSES

- **Academic — IIT Guwahati:** Interaction Design, Visual Design, Design Methods, Strategic Design Management, New Media Design, Information Visualization through Storytelling
- **Interaction Design Foundation:** AI for Designers, Mobile UX Strategy

EXTRACURRICULARS

- **Visual Identity, TEDx IIT Guwahati:** Designed brand merchandise adopted as official event apparel; contributed to overall event visual identity and supported event execution.
 - **Brand Design, SAIL IIT Guwahati:** Created merchandise and yearbook template designs, strengthening SAIL's visual brand presence and supporting institutional documentation.
 - **EY Techathon 4.0:** Competed in a national technology innovation competition organized by Ernst & Young.
 - **Design Workshops, IIT Guwahati:** Participated in "Ideas to Impact — Design Driven Innovation" and "Unmute Toolkit Launch Workshop."
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